

WEBSITE PROJECT PROPOSALS

CodeBridge & ThreadTHEORY

Non-Profit Organisation Websites — Part 1: Foundation (Proposal, Wireframes, Sitemap & Folder Structure)

Student Name: Mapuru Sebata

Student Number: ST10508015

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Lecturer: Ma'am Maggie Kalembo

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Note: CodeBridge & ThreadTheory are both a fictional organisation created for the purposes of this assignment and is not affiliated with, nor based on, any existing organisation of a similar name.

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Introduction

This document presents the Website Project Proposal for CodeBridge, developed to satisfy the Part 1 requirement of the Proof of Evidence (PoE). CodeBridge is a fictional non-profit organisation, presented with realistic, researched detail as instructed. Following lecturer feedback and approval of this proposal, the site will proceed through Part 2 (styling) and Part 3 (interactivity) of the PoE.

1. Organisation Overview

- **Name:** CodeBridge

CodeBridge is a fictional non-profit organisation founded in 2022 in Johannesburg by a small group of software engineers who began volunteering as weekend coding tutors at a community centre in Alexandra. Recognising the scale of youth unemployment and the shortage of accessible, practical digital-skills training in under-resourced communities, the founders formalised the initiative into a registered NPO in 2023. CodeBridge now runs short, practical coding bootcamps (HTML/CSS, JavaScript fundamentals, and basic computer literacy) from two community centres, and has supported over 120 learners to date.

- **Mission:** To equip unemployed and out-of-school youth in under-resourced communities with practical, job-ready digital and coding skills.
- **Vision:** A Johannesburg where every young person, regardless of background, has access to the digital skills needed to participate in the tech economy.
- **Target Audience:** Primary — unemployed or out-of-school youth aged 16–25 in townships and under-resourced areas around Johannesburg (e.g. Alexandra, Diepsloot). Secondary — corporate donors and sponsors, individual donors, and prospective volunteer instructors.

Context

Statistics South Africa's Q1 2026 Quarterly Labour Force Survey recorded youth unemployment (ages 15–34) at 45.8%, rising as high as 60.9% for those aged 15–24 (Statistics South Africa, 2026). This scale of joblessness is the exact problem CodeBridge's programmes — and therefore this website's application and volunteer-recruitment pathways — are designed to address.

2. Website Goals and Objectives

- Objective 1: Increase the number of monthly applications to CodeBridge's coding programmes by providing clear programme information and a simple online application process — measured by the “Programme applications / month” KPI below.
- Objective 2: Grow the number of recurring individual and corporate donors by presenting a trustworthy, transparent online donation channel — measured by the “Donation conversion rate” KPI below.
- Objective 3: Recruit volunteer coding instructors and mentors through a dedicated volunteer enquiry pathway — measured by the “Volunteer sign-ups” KPI below.

- Objective 4: Improve CodeBridge's discoverability so that youth searching for free coding classes in Johannesburg can find the organisation online — measured by the “Homepage bounce rate” and organic search visibility KPIs below.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPI	What it measures	Target
Programme applications / month	Effectiveness of programme info & application form	25+ applications/month within 3 months
Donation conversion rate	% of visitors who complete a donation	2% of unique visitors
Volunteer sign-ups	Interest from prospective instructors/mentors	5+ new volunteers/quarter
Average session duration	Engagement with programme & impact content	2+ minutes average
Homepage bounce rate	Relevance/clarity of homepage messaging	Below 50%

3. Current Website Analysis

CodeBridge does not currently have a dedicated website; its only online presence is a Facebook page updated irregularly by volunteers.

Strengths of current presence

- Active community engagement and photo updates from sessions build authenticity and trust.
- Existing follower base of parents, learners and local supporters.

Weaknesses of current presence

- No centralised, structured information about programmes, schedules or eligibility.
- No online application form — prospective learners must message the page directly and wait for a manual reply, causing delays and lost interest.
- No secure or convenient donation mechanism for supporters.
- Not indexed by search engines, so youth actively searching for “free coding classes Johannesburg” cannot discover CodeBridge.
- Inconsistent posting schedule makes the organisation appear inactive to new visitors.

Areas for Improvement

A dedicated, SEO-friendly website with structured programme pages, a functional application/enquiry form, a clear donation pathway, and consistent branding that builds donor and parent trust.

Benchmark Comparison

Similar local youth-skills NPOs typically run dedicated websites with a clear “Get Involved” pathway split by audience (learner / volunteer / donor), a visible impact-numbers section on the homepage, and a simple online donation button. Reach for a Dream (2026), for example, structures its site around exactly this kind of audience-specific pathway. CodeBridge's Facebook-only presence currently lacks all three, which is the core gap this proposed website addresses.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

- **Homepage** — hero section with mission statement, clear call-to-action (“Apply Now”), highlights of recent impact.
- **About Us** — organisational history, mission/vision, meet-the-team section.
- **Programmes page** — detailed breakdown of each coding programme, duration, prerequisites, and schedule.
- **Enquiry/Application page** — a single form supporting three enquiry types as required for NPOs: (1) learner programme application (fields: full name, age, contact number, preferred centre, programme of interest), (2) volunteer sign-up (fields: name, contact details, area of expertise, availability), and (3) sponsor/donor enquiry (fields: name, organisation, contact details, intended contribution type). All fields will use client-side validation (required-field checks and correct format for phone/email) before submission, to be implemented in Part 3.
- **Contact page** — contact details and an embedded map showing both community centre locations.
- **Donate page** — clear explanation of how donations are used, a suggested donation-amount selector, and a donation call-to-action button. Full payment processing is out of scope for Part 1–3 but the interface will be built to accommodate a future gateway integration (e.g. SnapScan or PayFast).
- **Privacy Policy page** — explains what personal information is collected through the site's forms, how it is used and protected, and learners'/donors' rights under South Africa's Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA).
- **Testimonials** — quotes and outcomes from past learners to build credibility.

5. Design and User Experience

- **Colour Scheme:** Primary teal (#2E7D6B) for trust and a technology feel, accented with warm orange (#F2994A) for energy and youth appeal, on a clean white background.
- **Typography:** Bold, modern sans-serif for headings (e.g. Poppins) to feel current and youth-oriented; a highly readable sans-serif (e.g. Open Sans) for body text to maximise accessibility across reading levels. Both are freely available, open-source web fonts (Google Fonts, 2026).
- **Layout and Design:** Clean, grid-based, mobile-first layout, since the target audience predominantly accesses the internet via smartphone. Generous white space and large tap targets for ease of use on smaller screens.

- **User Experience Considerations:** a single, consistent navigation menu across all pages; a short, jargon-free application form to minimise drop-off; high colour contrast for readability; and a clear visual hierarchy that leads first-time visitors straight to the “Apply Now” call-to-action.

Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

Body text and CTA text must meet a minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 against its background (3:1 for large text and UI components), per the W3C's Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (W3C, 2023). The primary teal (#2E7D6B) against a white background measures approximately 4.9:1, which passes the requirement for normal body text. Body text will be set no smaller than 16px, with headings using a clear size hierarchy (e.g. 32px/24px/18px) to remain readable at default browser zoom.

Low-Fidelity Wireframes

Low-fidelity wireframes were developed for each major page to visualise the site's layout and information hierarchy before any visual design work begins, following standard UX practice (Nielsen Norman Group, 2020):

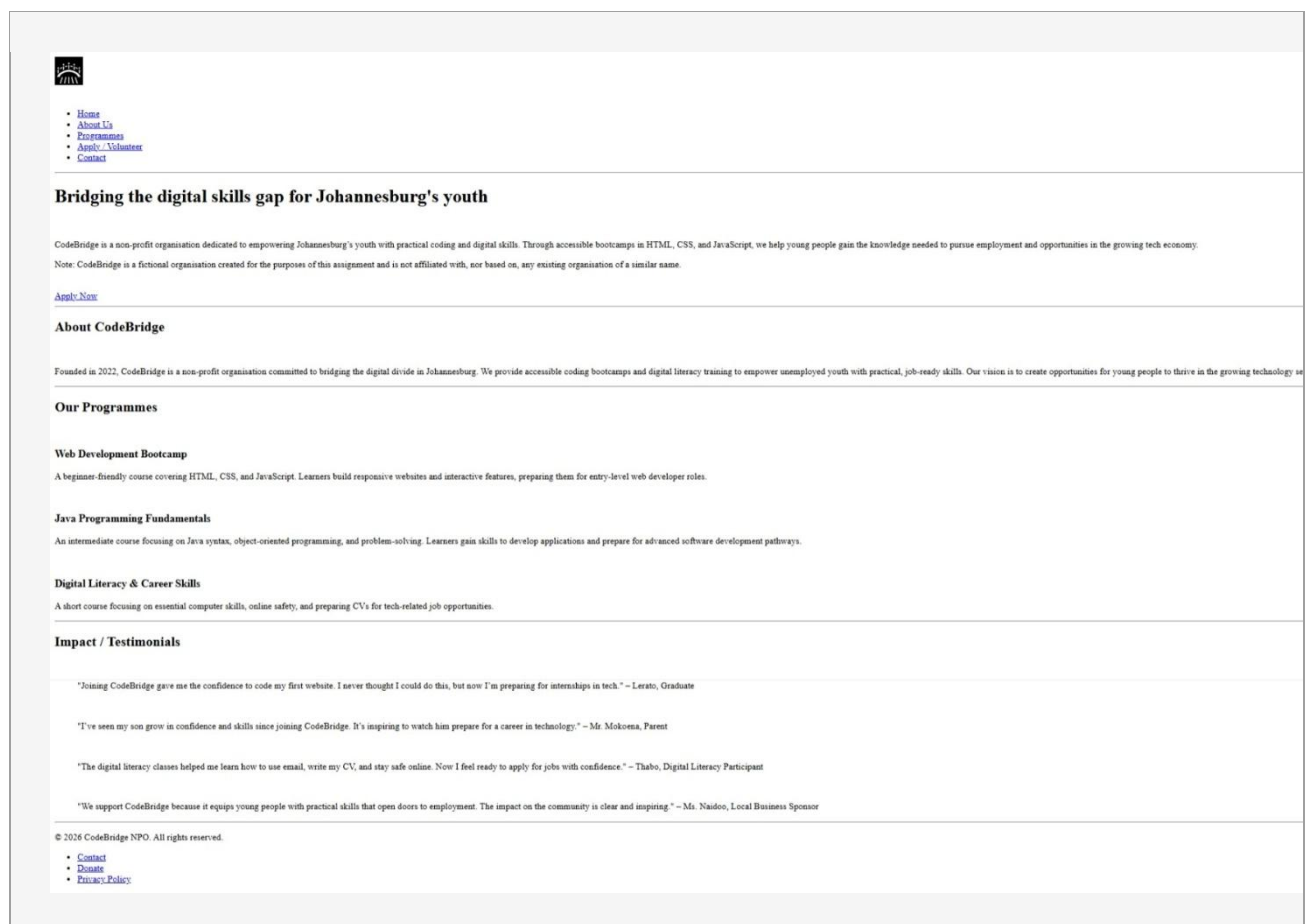


Figure 1: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge homepage layout



- [Home](#)
- [About Us](#)
- [Programmes](#)
- [Apply / Volunteer](#)
- [Contact](#)

Apply / Volunteer / Sponsor

Whether you want to join one of our programmes as a learner, give your time as a volunteer, or support CodeBridge as a sponsor, this page is your starting point. Select the enquiry type that applies to you and complete the form below, and a member of the CodeBridge team will be in touch.

Enquiry Type

What are you enquiring about?

-- please choose --

▼

Your Details

Full Name

Contact Number

Email Address

Learner Application Details

Preferred Centre

-- please choose --

▼

Programme of Interest

-- please choose --

▼

Short Motivation

↻

Submit

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- [Contact](#)
- [Donate](#)
- [Privacy Policy](#)

Figure 2: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge Apply/Volunteer/Sponsor enquiry page



- [Home](#)
- [About Us](#)
- [Programmes](#)
- [Apply / Volunteer](#)
- [Contact](#)

About CodeBridge

Empowering Johannesburg's youth through practical digital skills.

Our Story



Students learning coding fundamentals at a community workshop.

CodeBridge is a fictional non-profit organisation founded in Johannesburg in 2022 by a small team of passionate software engineers. The organisation began as a weekend volunteer initiative, where coding mentors taught basic programming skills to young people at a local community centre in Alexandra.

As interest in the programme continued to grow, the founders officially registered CodeBridge as a non-profit organisation in 2023. Since then, the organisation has expanded its reach by offering practical coding bootcamps in HTML, CSS, JavaScript fundamentals and basic computer literacy.

Today, CodeBridge continues to empower young people by providing practical digital skills that improve employment opportunities while helping bridge the digital divide in under-resourced communities across Johannesburg.

Mission & Vision

Our Mission

Our mission is to equip unemployed and out-of-school youth in under-resourced communities with practical, job-ready digital and coding skills that improve their confidence, employment opportunities and future careers.

Our Vision

Our vision is to create a Johannesburg where every young person, regardless of their background or financial circumstances, has access to quality digital education and the opportunity to participate in the growing technology industry.

Our Values

- **Accessibility:** We believe every young person deserves equal access to technology education.
- **Innovation:** We encourage creativity, curiosity and continuous learning.
- **Community:** We build supportive learning environments where everyone feels welcome.
- **Integrity:** We operate with honesty, transparency and accountability.
- **Empowerment:** We help learners develop practical skills that prepare them for future careers.

Meet the Team



Mapuru Sebata leading a community coding workshop.

Mapuru Sebata

Founder & Programme Director

Mapuru founded CodeBridge with the vision of making technology education accessible to every young person. His passion for software development and community development drives the organisation's mission to prepare learners with practical digital skills for the future.

Why Choose CodeBridge?



Students participating in a CodeBridge workshop.

Practical Learning

Our programmes focus on hands-on projects that help learners build practical coding experience instead of only learning theory.

Experienced Mentors

Learners receive guidance from passionate volunteers who are committed to helping young people succeed in technology.

Career Preparation

We equip learners with valuable digital skills that improve confidence, employability and future career opportunities within the technology industry.

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- [Contact](#)
- [Donate](#)
- [Privacy Policy](#)

Figure 3: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge About Us page

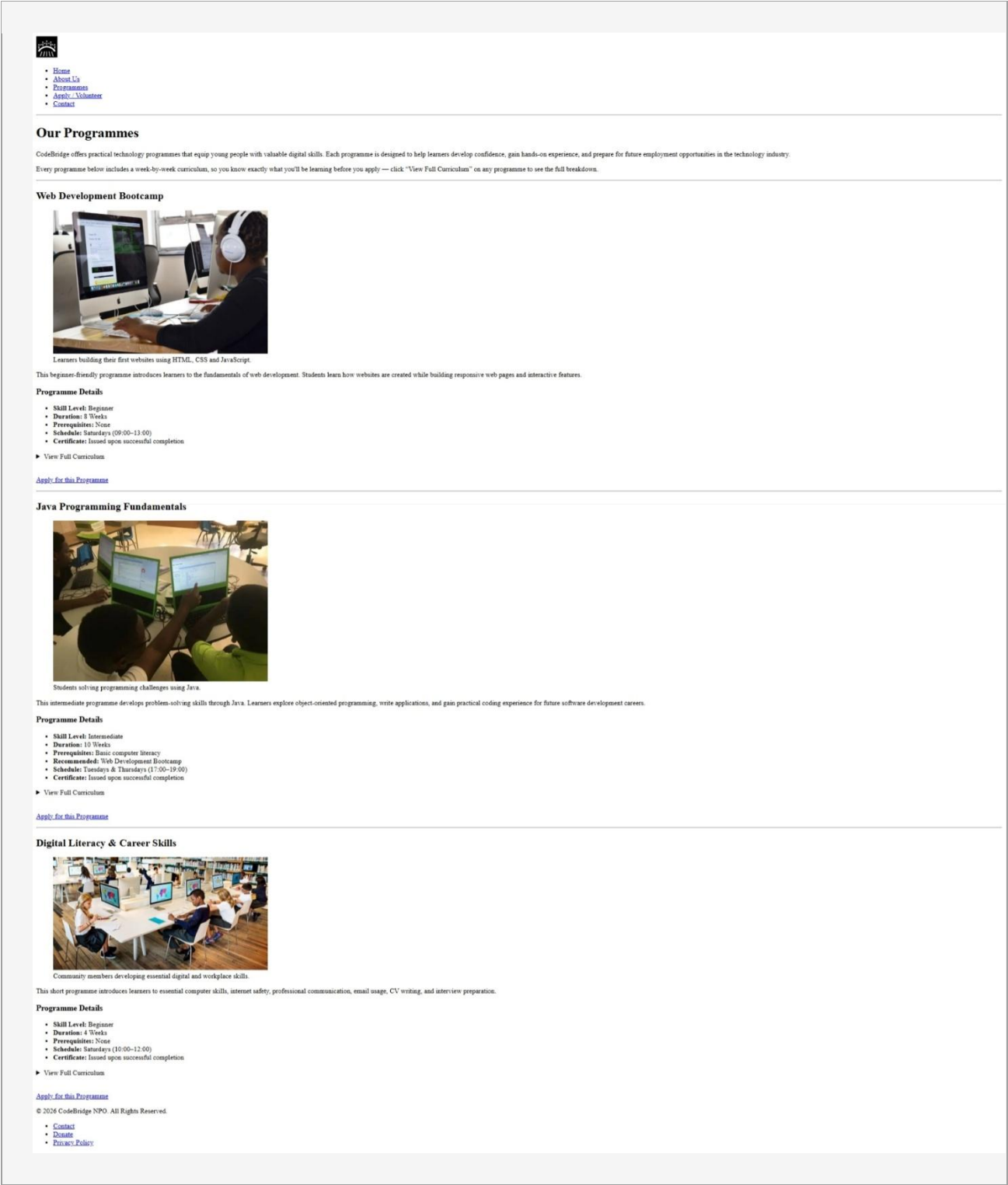


Figure 4: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge Programmes page

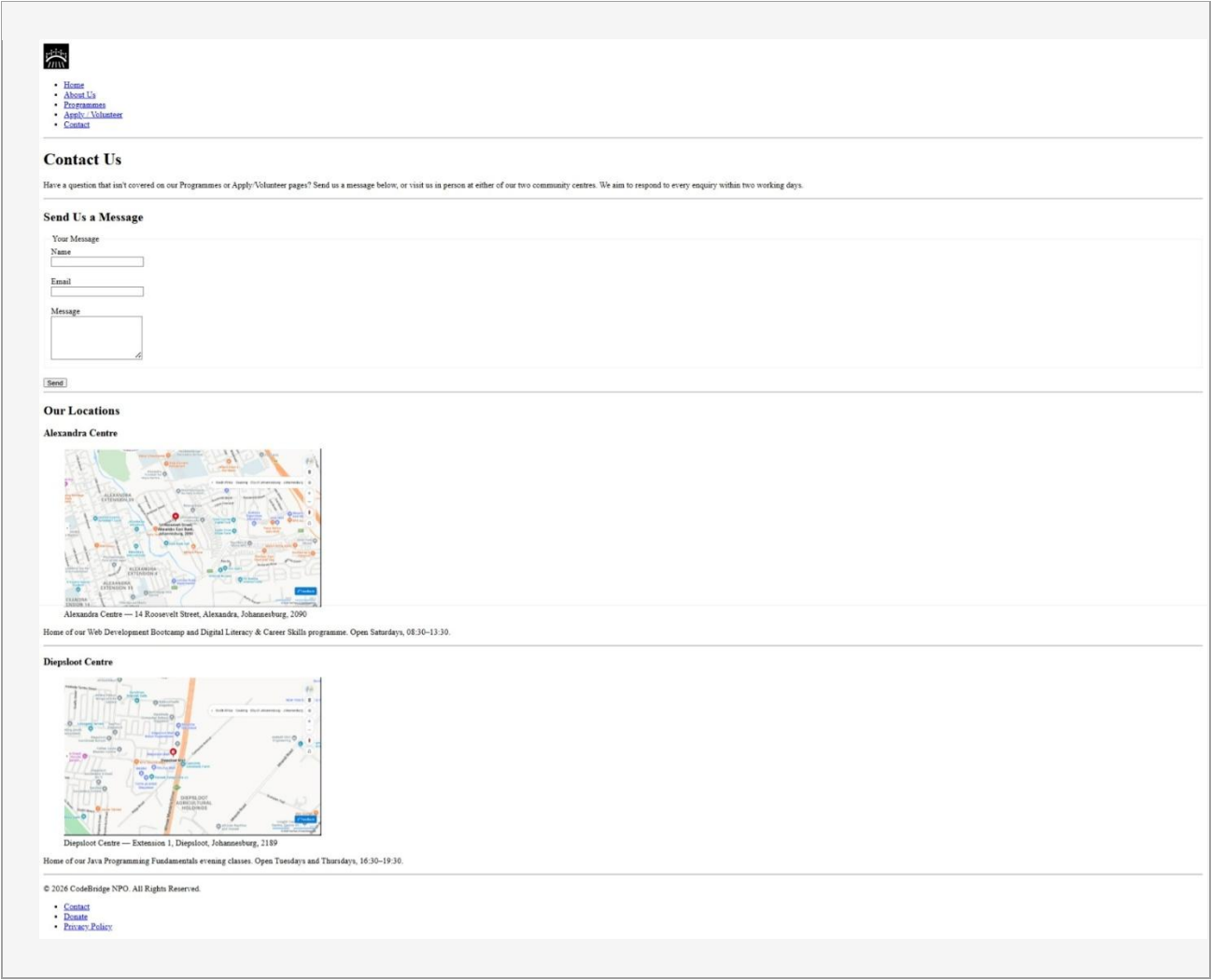


Figure 5: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge Contact page (multi-location map)

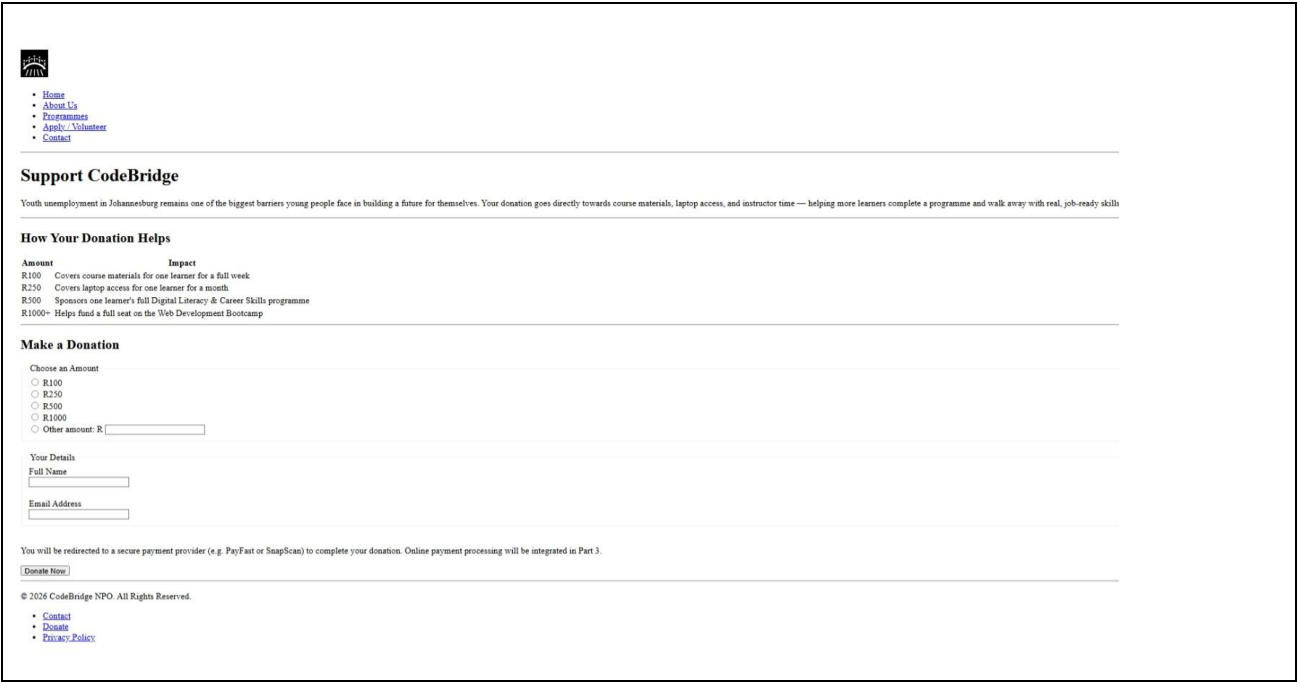


Figure 6: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge Donate page

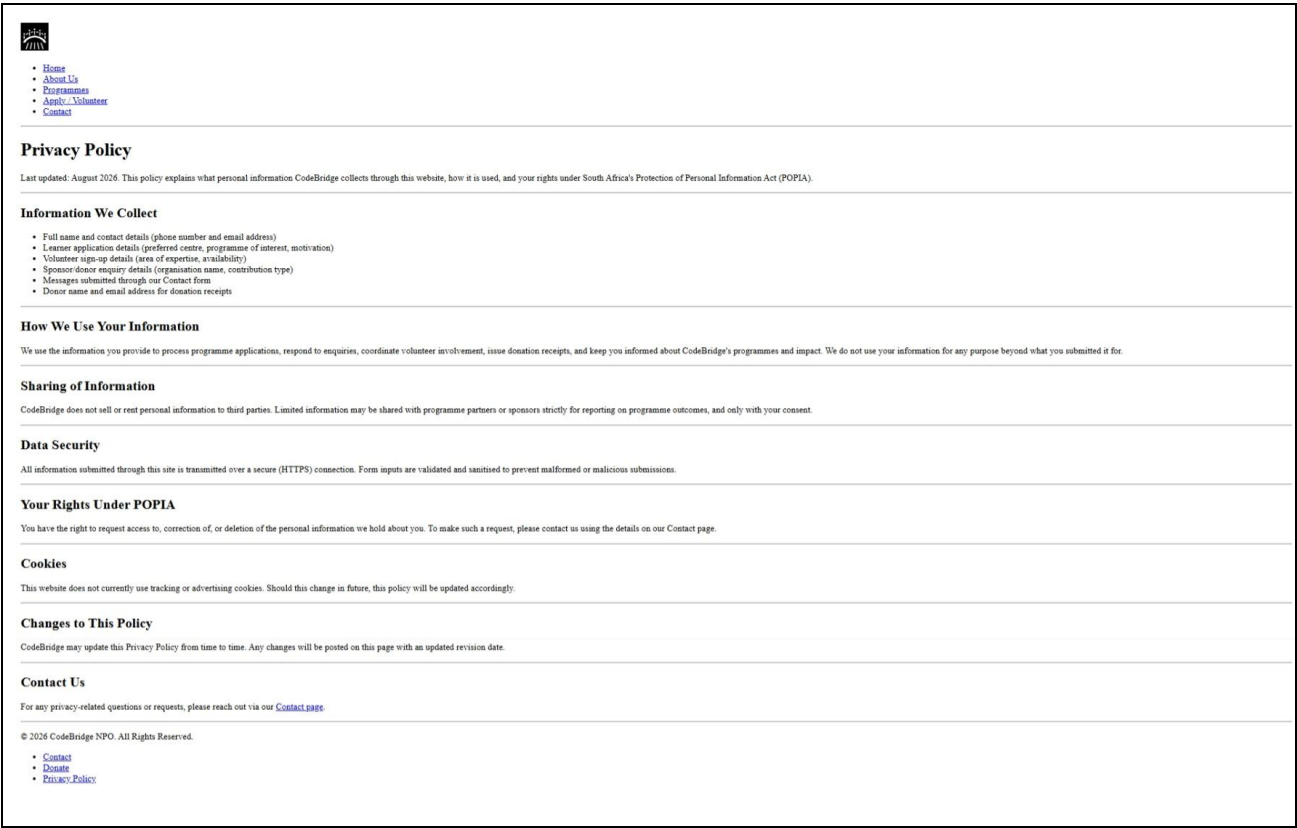


Figure 7: Low-fidelity wireframe — CodeBridge Privacy page

6. Technical Requirements

- **Core languages:** HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript (JS for Part 1–3; no framework required at this scale).
- **Hosting:** affordable South African shared hosting (e.g. Afrihost or Web4Africa) for the live production site, with entry-tier pricing used to inform the budget in Section 8 (Afrihost, 2026); GitHub Pages usable as a free staging/preview environment during development.
- **Domain name:** a .org.za domain (e.g. www.codebridge.org.za) to reinforce the organisation's local, non-profit identity.
- **Browser compatibility:** tested on the latest two versions of Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari (desktop and mobile), covering the large majority of the target audience's likely devices.
- **Performance:** homepage target load time under 3 seconds on a standard mobile 4G connection; images optimised/compressed before upload to reduce data usage for cost-sensitive users.

- **Security:** HTTPS enforced site-wide via a free SSL certificate (e.g. Let's Encrypt, typically included with hosting); form inputs sanitised and validated to prevent malformed submissions.
- **Accessibility:** semantic HTML5 elements (W3Schools, 2026) and WCAG 2.2 AA colour contrast (see Section 5) to support screen-reader and low-literacy users.
- **Responsiveness:** mobile-first CSS to be implemented in Part 2, since the majority of the target audience will access the site via smartphone.

7. Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	What it Covers	Target Date
Part 1 – Foundation	Proposal approval, research, sitemap, folder structure, initial HTML pages	7 – 14 August 2026
Part 2 – Styling	CSS styling, responsive layout, branding applied	15 August – 18 September 2026
Part 3 – Interactivity	JavaScript functionality (forms, validation, dynamic content)	19 September 2026 – date TBC (to be confirmed once released by module guide)
Final Review	Cross-browser testing, debugging, final polish	Final week before Part 3 submission

8. Budget

Item	Estimated Cost (ZAR)	Frequency
Domain registration (.org.za)	R199	Annual
Shared web hosting (entry tier)	R119	Monthly
Stock imagery / icons	R0 (CC0 / public domain sources)	Once-off
Development time (volunteer developer, valued at market rate but donated in-kind)	R0 paid — valued at approx. R15,000 equivalent	Once-off
Ongoing maintenance / minor updates	R80	Monthly
Estimated first-year cash outlay (excl. in-kind dev time)	≈ R2,587	—

9. References

Afrihost, 2026. Web hosting South Africa. [online] Available at: <<https://www.afrihost.com>> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Google Fonts, 2026. Poppins and Open Sans font families. [online] Available at: <<https://fonts.google.com>> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Nielsen Norman Group, 2020. Wireframing: The First Step in Building an Intuitive Product. [online] Available at: <<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/wireframing/>> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Reach for a Dream, 2026. About us and get-involved pathways. [online] Available at: <<https://reachforadream.org.za>> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Statistics South Africa, 2026. South Africa's Youth and the Labour Market in Q1 2026. [online] Available at: <<https://www.statssa.gov.za/?p=19526>> [Accessed 7 August 2026].

W3C, 2023. Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2. [online] Available at: <<https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/>> [Accessed 7 August 2026].

W3Schools, 2026. HTML5 Semantic Elements. [online] Available at: <https://www.w3schools.com/html/html5_semantic_elements.asp> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Appendix A: Visual Sitemaps

The diagram below shows the page hierarchy for CodeBridge, included here for convenience alongside the wireframes. This will be submitted again as part of the separate Website Structure and Planning deliverable once the organisation is approved, per the module brief.

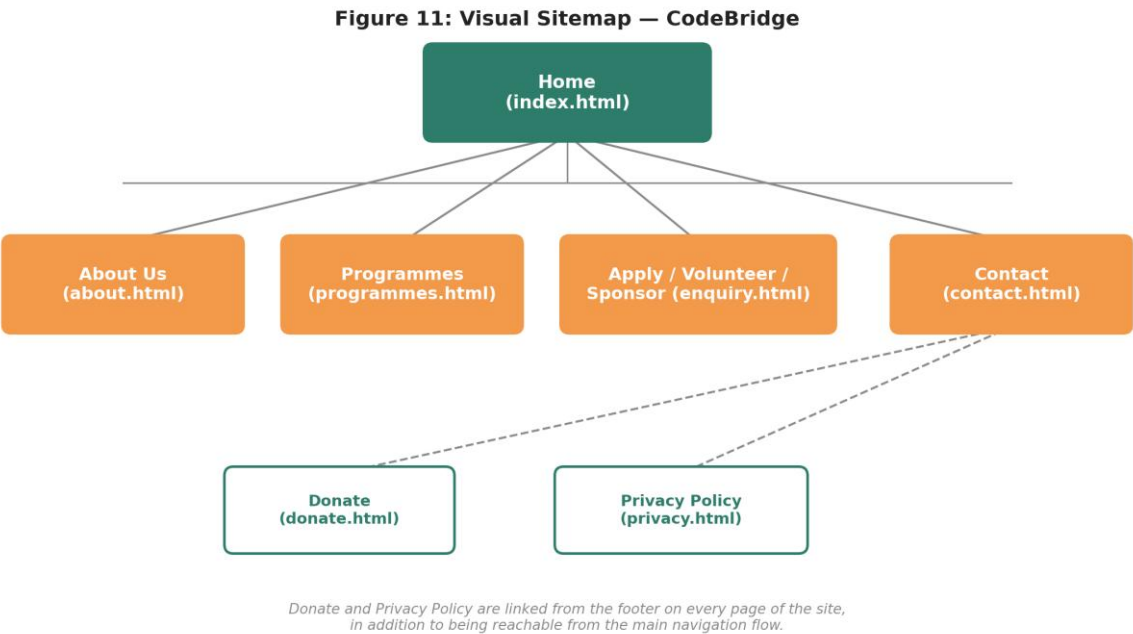


Figure 11: Visual sitemap

Proposal 2: Thread Theory (Retail Store)

1. Organisation Overview

Name: Thread Theory

Thread Theory is a fictional streetwear brand founded in 2024 in Johannesburg by three friends who began selling limited runs of designed apparel through Instagram direct messages. Demand quickly outgrew what could be managed manually, and the founders now plan to launch a dedicated online store to support structured “drop” releases — limited-quantity product launches at scheduled times, a model popular within streetwear culture.

Mission: To bring limited, high-quality streetwear drops to South African youth at accessible prices, while championing local design talent.

Vision: To become the go-to online destination for authentic, homegrown South African streetwear drops.

Target Audience: Primary: 16–30 year olds interested in streetwear and sneaker culture, digitally native and highly active on social media. Secondary: local streetwear collectors and resellers.

2. Website Goals and Objectives

- Objective 1: Increase online sales conversion by replacing manual DM-based ordering with a secure, self-service online store — measured by the “Conversion rate” KPI below.
- Objective 2: Grow the email/waitlist subscriber base so customers can be notified ahead of new drops — measured by the “Waitlist sign-ups” KPI below.
- Objective 3: Reduce cart abandonment through a clear, low-friction checkout process — measured by the “Cart abandonment rate” KPI below.
- Objective 4: Build repeat purchase behaviour through a memorable, high-energy brand experience — measured by the “Repeat purchase rate” KPI below.

Benchmark note: the global average cart-abandonment rate across e-commerce is approximately 70% (Baymard Institute, 2025). Thread Theory's cart abandonment target below is set to meaningfully beat this global benchmark rather than against an arbitrary figure.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

KPI	What it measures	Target
-----	------------------	--------

Conversion rate	% of visitors who complete a purchase	3%+ per drop
Average order value (AOV)	Revenue efficiency per transaction	R850+
Waitlist sign-ups	Anticipation/interest ahead of a drop	200+ per drop
Cart abandonment rate	Checkout friction	Below 65% (vs. ~70% global average)
Repeat purchase rate	Customer loyalty	20%+ within 6 months

3. Current Website Analysis

Thread Theory currently sells exclusively via Instagram direct messages and WhatsApp, with no dedicated website.

Strengths of current presence:

- Strong, engaged social media following with an authentic streetwear-community voice.
- Existing product photography and brand identity already established on Instagram.

Weaknesses of current presence:

- No secure online payment method — orders and payments are confirmed manually, which is slow and error-prone.
- No real-time stock visibility, resulting in oversold items and frustrated customers.
- Slow manual response times to DMs during high-demand drops causes missed sales.
- No structured way for customers to browse the full product catalogue at once.

Areas for improvement: a dedicated e-commerce site with a real-time stock display, secure cart and checkout, and a structured, filterable product catalogue.

Benchmark comparison: established local streetwear retailers run dedicated online stores with live stock counters, drop countdowns, and waitlist capture — features that directly drive urgency and repeat traffic. Sneaker Lab (2026), for instance, structures its entire online store around this kind of stock-driven urgency. Thread Theory's current DM-based process has none of these mechanisms, meaning it is losing the exact urgency-driven sales behaviour that makes the drop model work elsewhere.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

- Homepage — hero banner with live drop countdown and a clear “Shop the Drop” call-to-action.
- Shop/Catalogue page — full product grid with filtering by size, colour, and price.
- Product detail page — size/colour variant selector, stock-level indicator, and “Add to Cart” action.
- Cart and checkout page — editable quantities, live subtotal calculation, delivery-details form (name, address, contact number) with required-field validation, and an order summary step before final confirmation. On successful order, an automated confirmation email is sent (order number, itemised summary, estimated delivery window); a basic order-status page (Processing → Shipped → Delivered) provides order tracking. Checkout is designed to accommodate a future local payment gateway (PayFast or Ozow) with clear error states for failed or declined payments, to be wired up once JavaScript functionality is introduced in Part 3.
- Waitlist / “Notify Me” — email capture (with format validation) for sold-out items and upcoming drops.
- About page — brand story and design philosophy, supported by editorial/community imagery (product photography is original; supporting lifestyle imagery sourced from free, properly licensed platforms such as Unsplash, 2026).
- Contact/FAQ page — shipping, returns, and sizing information, with multiple contact/collection points shown on a map.

5. Design and User Experience

Colour Scheme: High-contrast black and white base with a single neon accent (electric green, #39FF14) used sparingly for urgency cues such as “Low Stock” or “Drop Live”.

Typography: Bold, condensed sans-serif for headings (e.g. Bebas Neue, freely available via Google Fonts, 2026) to convey streetwear energy; a clean, minimal sans-serif for body copy to keep product information easy to scan.

Layout and Design: Image-forward, grid-based product layout, mobile-first, with high visual contrast used deliberately to draw attention to scarcity and urgency messaging.

User experience considerations: a persistent, always-visible cart icon with item count; minimal steps between product page and checkout; and clear stock/urgency indicators so customers understand availability at a glance.

Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA): checked against the 4.5:1 minimum contrast ratio for normal text (W3C, 2023), black (#111111) on white passes comfortably ($\approx 19:1$). The neon green accent (#39FF14), however, measures only $\approx 1.4:1$ against white — a clear fail — so it will be used exclusively as a

background/graphic accent on the black UI (where it measures $\approx 13.9:1$), never as body text on a light background. This constraint will be carried into the CSS colour system in Part 2.

Low-fidelity wireframes were developed for each major page to visualise the site's layout and information hierarchy before any visual design work begins, following standard UX practice (Nielsen Norman Group, 2020):

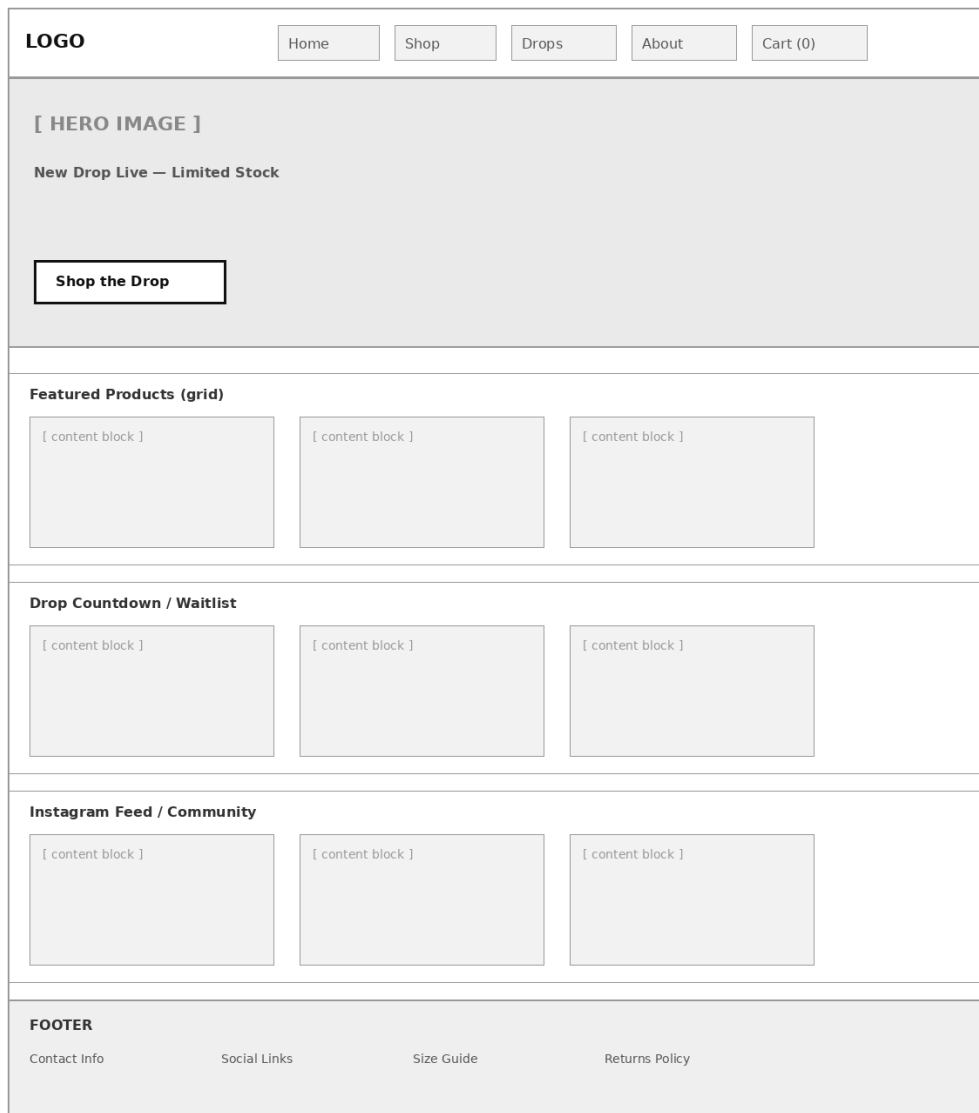


Figure 6: Low-fidelity wireframe — Thread Theory homepage layout

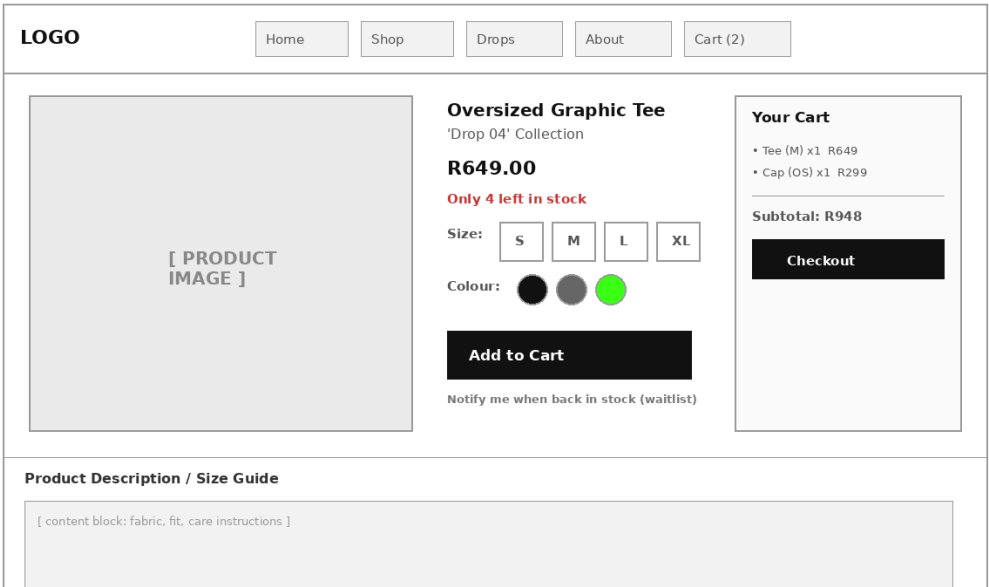


Figure 7: Low-fidelity wireframe — Thread Theory product detail page with cart

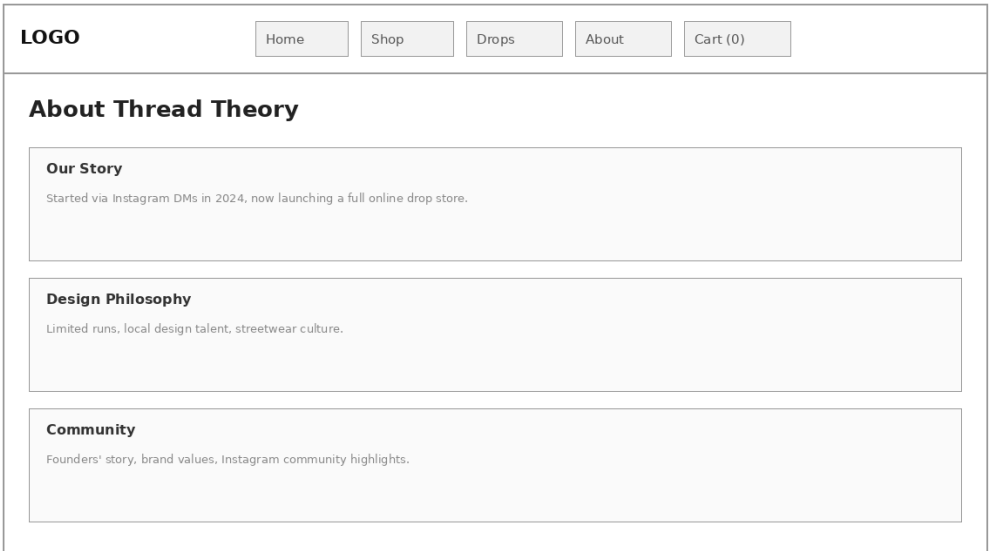


Figure 8: Low-fidelity wireframe — Thread Theory About page

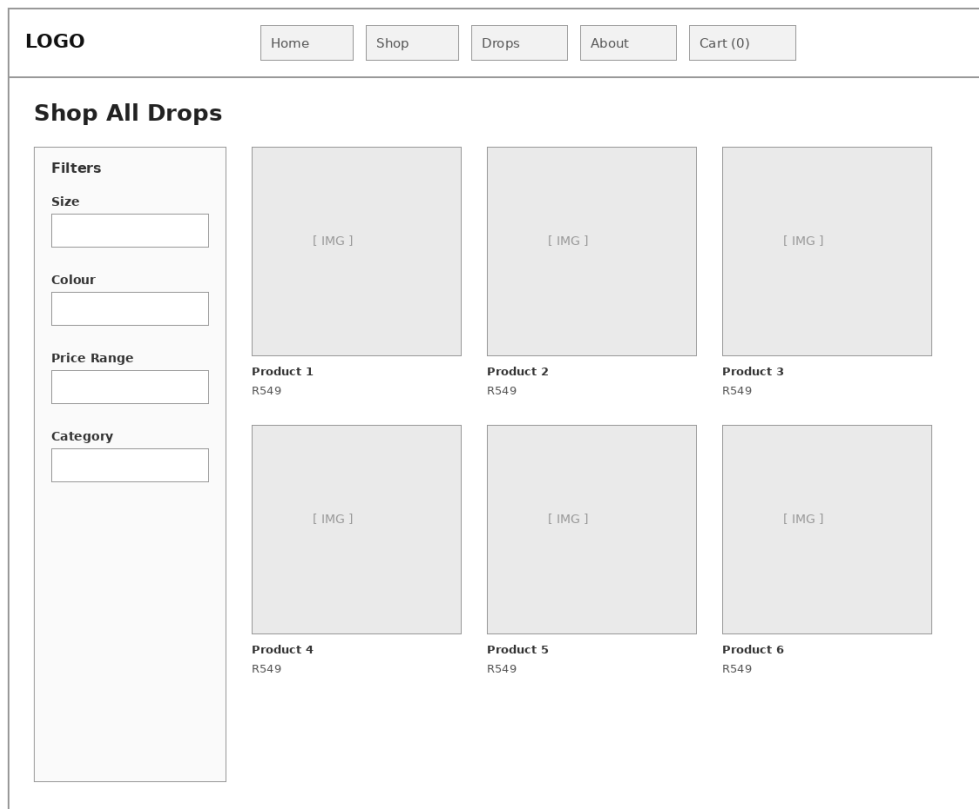


Figure 9: Low-fidelity wireframe — Thread Theory Shop/Catalogue page with filters

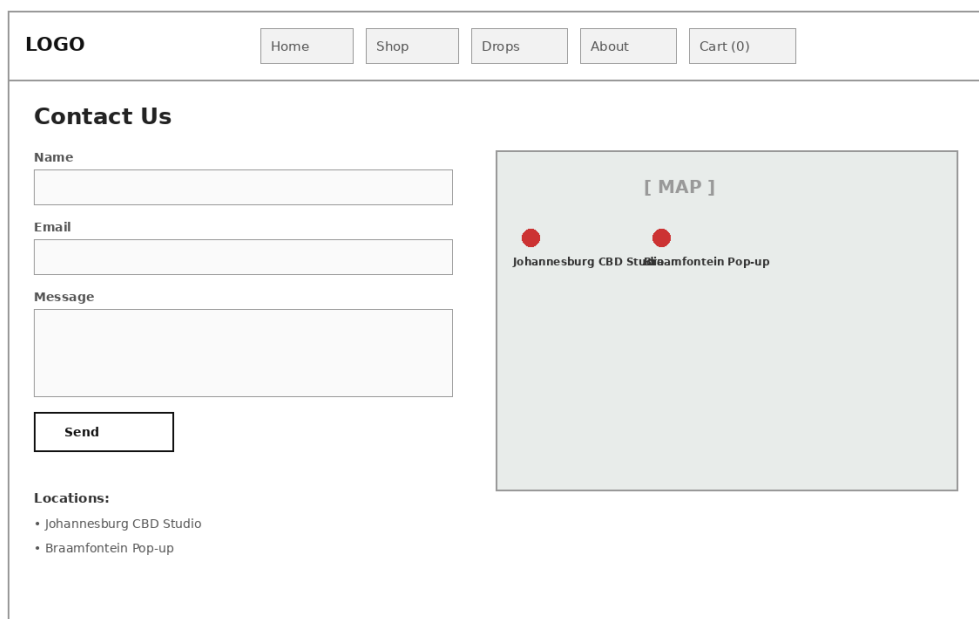


Figure 10: Low-fidelity wireframe — Thread Theory Contact page (multi-location map)

6. Technical Requirements

- Core languages: HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript — JavaScript is central here, driving cart logic, live stock indicators, and countdown timers (Part 3).
- Hosting: South African shared or cloud hosting capable of supporting future payment-gateway integration.

- Domain name: a .co.za domain (e.g. www.threadtheory.co.za) for local brand credibility.
- Browser compatibility: tested on the latest two versions of Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari (desktop and mobile), with particular attention to mobile Safari/Chrome given the youth mobile-first audience.
- Performance: product and catalogue pages target under 3 seconds load time; product images compressed and lazy-loaded to keep the catalogue page fast.
- Security: HTTPS enforced site-wide via SSL certificate — non-negotiable once a payment gateway is introduced; all cart/checkout form inputs validated and sanitised.
- Future payment integration (beyond current PoE scope): a local gateway such as PayFast (2026) or Ozow (2026), both purpose-built for South African e-commerce.
- Responsiveness: mobile-first design, since streetwear customers predominantly shop via smartphone.

7. Timeline and Milestones

KPI	What it measures	Target
Part 1 – Foundation	Proposal approval, research, sitemap, folder structure, initial HTML pages	7 – 14 August 2026
Part 2 – Styling	CSS styling, responsive layout, brand identity applied	15 August – 18 September 2026
Part 3 – Interactivity	Cart logic, variant selectors, countdown timers, form validation	19 September 2026 – date TBC (to be confirmed once released by module guide)
Final Review	Cross-browser testing, debugging, final polish	Final week before Part 3 submission

8. Budget

Item	Estimated Cost (ZAR)	Frequency
Domain registration (.co.za)	R199	Annual
Shared/cloud web hosting (entry tier)	R179	Monthly

Product photography (per drop)	R650	Per drop (est. 4 drops/yr)
Payment gateway fees (future)	approx. 3.0% per transaction	Ongoing, on sales only
Development time (volunteer developer, valued at market rate but donated in-kind)	R0 paid — valued at approx. R18,000 equivalent	Once-off
Estimated first-year cash outlay (excl. transaction fees)	≈ R4,975	

Transaction fee impact: at a projected average order value (AOV) of R850 and a 3.0% gateway fee, each order costs approximately R25.50 in processing fees. At an estimated 40 orders/month once live, this equals roughly R1,020/month (≈ R12,240/year) in transaction costs — a recurring cost that scales directly with sales volume rather than a fixed overhead, and is factored separately from the fixed costs above since it only applies once a payment gateway is live.

9. References — Thread Theory

Sources consulted specifically for the Thread Theory proposal (e-commerce/retail conventions, payment gateway options, and drop-model design patterns):

Baymard Institute, 2025. Cart Abandonment Rate Statistics (meta-analysis of 49 studies). [online] Available at: <<https://baymard.com/lists/cart-abandonment-rate>> [Accessed 7 August 2026].

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<https://www.w3schools.com/html/html5_semantic_elements.asp> [Accessed 6 August 2026].

Appendix B: Visual Sitemaps

The diagrams below show the page hierarchy for each proposed organisation, included here for convenience alongside the wireframes. These will be submitted again as part of the separate Website Structure and Planning deliverable once the organisation is approved, per the module brief.

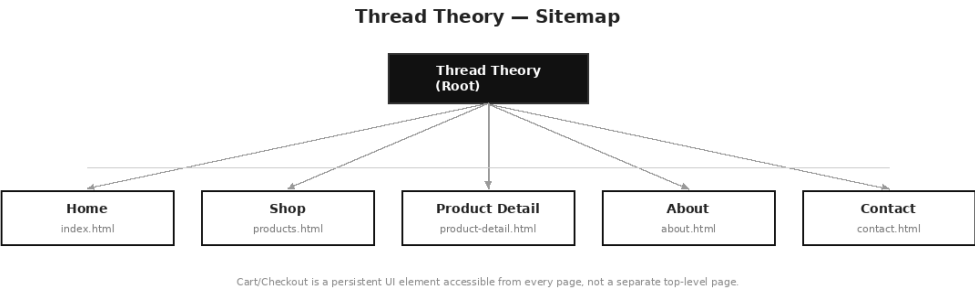


Figure 12: Visual sitemap — Thread Theory